

SELECTION ROUND

12 challenges. 16 teams.

Choose one challenge, build a working prototype, deploy it and submit it for shortlisting.

SUBMISSION DEADLINE

19 SEPTEMBER 2026

Shortlisted teams announced: 20 September 2026

12

selection challenges

16

teams shortlisted

2

members per team

₹0

registration fee

Who can apply?

Undergraduate and postgraduate students from any discipline and any state in India may apply. Each team must have exactly two members.

What happens after selection?

The 16 shortlisted teams will take part in the main ANAVANDI Hackathon on 23-24 September 2026. Teams will build overnight at the Jain Kochi campus, travel to Munnar by KSRTC coach, pitch their work and receive results at Munnar.

WHAT IS PROVIDED

Free entry - Travel from the Jain Kochi campus to Munnar and back, meals during the event, and the ANAVANDI hackathon kit are provided.

Participants must arrange their own travel to reach the Jain Kochi campus before reporting time.

PICK ONE. BUILD IT. DEPLOY IT. SUBMIT IT.

HOW SELECTION WORKS

Show us what your team can build.

A small project that works is stronger than a large idea that is incomplete.

Submit these two items

01

Deployed prototype

A live URL that the reviewers can open. A repository or a localhost video is not a deployed prototype.

02

Presentation deck (PPT or PDF)

Maximum eight slides. Add the shareable PPT, PDF or presentation link using the slide order shown on page 6.

Important: selection task vs. hackathon task

The 12 challenges in this document are only for shortlisting.

At the main hackathon, teams will receive one of eight different sealed problem statements. Those problems will be revealed only at 17:00 on 23 September.

Do not reuse your selection prototype or its code during the main hackathon. Every line submitted at the event must be written after coding starts at 18:00 on 23 September.

Use of AI tools

AI tools, open-source libraries and public datasets are allowed for the selection project. Clearly mention what tools you used and how you used them. Reviewers are evaluating your decisions, working prototype and understanding of the problem.

SUBMISSION METHOD

Update the existing registration form with the live link and PPT. Use the same registered email and exact team name.

TRACK 1

Public Transport

Choose one challenge from SC-01 to SC-04.

SC-01 Digital student concession pass

Problem: Paper concession passes need in-person renewal, can be damaged and are easy to copy.

Build: Create an app where a student applies, uploads proof of enrolment and receives a verifiable digital pass. A conductor should verify it offline on a basic phone in under five seconds, without typing.

A complete submission should show: Apply, approve, issue and offline verification working end to end.

SC-02 Parcel booking and tracking on state buses

Problem: Parcel booking is mostly handled at counters, and senders cannot easily track where a parcel is.

Build: Create a booking and tracking tool between two stations. The sender receives a reference number, and the destination station can see parcels arriving on each service.

A complete submission should show: Booking, status updates and a public tracking page that works using only the reference number.

SC-03 Late-night journey safety companion

Problem: A person travelling alone at night may have no simple way to share progress or raise an alert after a missed arrival.

Build: Create a journey-sharing tool. The traveller shares a route and expected arrival with a trusted contact. The tool should continue safely when the mobile signal drops.

A complete submission should show: Share, follow, arrival check-in and missed-check-in escalation working.

SC-04 Printed timetable to structured data

Problem: Many bus timetables are available only as boards, photographs or PDFs, so trip-planning tools cannot read them.

Build: Create a tool that converts an imperfect timetable image or PDF into structured route, stop and time data. Support mixed Malayalam and English and provide a manual correction step.

A complete submission should show: A real timetable image going in and clean, editable structured data coming out.

TRACK 2

Water and Coast

Choose one challenge from SC-05 to SC-08.

SC-05 Water tanker booking and tracking

Problem: When piped water fails, bookings happen by phone with little price transparency and uncertain delivery times.

Build: Create a platform for households and tanker operators with visible pricing, delivery slots and tracking. Add a local-body view showing where tanker demand is highest.

A complete submission should show: A working two-sided booking flow and a demand map.

SC-06 Household water use and leak detection

Problem: Many households discover a leak only when the next bill arrives.

Build: Create a tool for recording meter readings, viewing consumption patterns and warning users when usage suggests a leak. Compare with similar households so warnings are meaningful.

A complete submission should show: A working logger and anomaly detector that finds an injected leak without flagging normal changes.

SC-07 Fish catch and market price transparency

Problem: Small-scale fishers may not know the price offered for the same catch at other landing centres.

Build: Create a low-literacy tool where fishers and buyers record species, quantity and price. Show current and recent prices across centres using simple icons or voice support.

A complete submission should show: Logging and comparison working across at least three landing centres.

SC-08 Canal and storm-drain blockage reporting

Problem: Blocked drains may go unreported because residents do not know which authority or ward should respond.

Build: Create a photo-and-location reporting tool that identifies the correct local-body ward, creates a ticket, shows public status and escalates unresolved reports.

A complete submission should show: Report, ward identification, ticket, status, escalation and an open-report map working end to end.

TRACK 3

Public Welfare

Choose one challenge from SC-09 to SC-12.

SC-09 Ration shop stock visibility

Problem: Cardholders may travel to a ration shop without knowing whether the items they need are available.

Build: Create a tool showing current stock at nearby ration shops. Allow shops or cardholders to update the information and notify households when a needed item arrives.

A complete submission should show: Stock display for several shops, an update method and a credible way to keep the data trustworthy.

SC-10 Medicine availability in government pharmacies

Problem: Patients may visit several public facilities before finding a prescribed medicine.

Build: Create a nearby-availability search for government pharmacies and health centres. Show generic equivalents when appropriate and clearly display when the stock data was last updated.

A complete submission should show: Search across at least five facilities, generic substitution and visible data freshness.

SC-11 Elderly care check-in and coordination

Problem: Coordination between a homebound senior, neighbour, caregiver, health worker and distant family is often informal.

Build: Create an accessible check-in schedule, a missed-check-in escalation flow and a family view for people living outside the state. Use large text and very few taps.

A complete submission should show: Scheduling, check-in, escalation and remote family monitoring working.

SC-12 District blood donor matching

Problem: Broad WhatsApp requests often reach the wrong people and repeatedly disturb donors who are not currently eligible.

Build: Create a system that matches a request with eligible nearby donors by blood group, location and donation interval. Keep contact details private until a donor accepts.

A complete submission should show: Request, match, notify and accept working, with interval rules and donor privacy enforced.

EVALUATION AND SUBMISSION

How the 16 teams are shortlisted.

Reviewers will score the deployed prototype and PPT using the same 100-point framework.

Selection score

35%

Working deployed prototype

The live link opens and the main user flow works.

25%

Problem understanding

The team understands the user and current situation, ideally through a real conversation or observation.

25%

Technical approach and quality

The solution is sensible, reliable and appropriately built for the selected problem.

15%

PPT clarity

The presentation explains the problem, product, working features and limitations clearly.

The 16 highest-scoring eligible teams will be shortlisted.

Your eight-slide deck

1. Challenge selected and why
2. Who has this problem and what they do today
3. What you built - one clear sentence
4. Live product screenshots
5. How it works - architecture, stack and data
6. What works now and what does not
7. What you would improve with two more weeks
8. Team names, institution and contact details

UPDATE PROJECT DETAILS



Registration form
forms.gle/iPRFq7zTfPL84Dqq9

JOIN WHATSAPP CHANNEL



All official communication
Join the ANAVANDI channel